

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Threat Detection Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | KQL | MITRE ATT&CK

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Detection Engineer and Cyber Security professional with over five years of hands-on experience building and operating detection capabilities across Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), and CrowdStrike Falcon. I specialise in authoring, tuning, and validating detection rules using Kusto Query Language (KQL), mapping detection coverage to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, and developing Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks that reduce analyst toil and accelerate response. I have led detection engineering initiatives across cloud, endpoint, and identity telemetry for an 8,000-user enterprise, and I bring deep knowledge of attacker tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs), threat hunting methodology, and incident response lifecycle management. I am passionate about detection as a craft and committed to continually improving coverage, reducing false positives, and enabling faster, risk-based decision-making for Security Operations Centre (SOC) teams.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Detection Engineering:** KQL (advanced query development, analytics rules, hunting queries), MITRE ATT&CK framework mapping, use case development, detection content lifecycle management, false-positive reduction and tuning
- **SIEM:** Microsoft Sentinel (analytics rules, workbooks, watchlists, data connectors, custom logs); CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM); Splunk (SPL queries)
- **XDR and EDR:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender (M365D); CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, Falcon Discover
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel Logic App playbooks; CrowdStrike Fusion SOAR; PowerShell scripting; automated alert triage and incident routing
- **Cloud Security Telemetry:** Azure AD / Microsoft Entra ID sign-in and audit logs; Microsoft 365 unified audit logs; Azure Defender / Microsoft Defender for Cloud
- **Threat Hunting:** Hypothesis-driven threat hunting using KQL, MITRE ATT&CK, and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight; proactive hunting for lateral movement, persistence, credential access, and exfiltration TTPs
- **Incident Response:** End-to-end incident lifecycle management per NIST 800-61; containment, eradication, recovery, and lessons-learned reporting
- **Identity Security:** Microsoft Entra ID (Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, Privileged Identity Management); BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Engineer

March 2025 - Present

University of the Arts London (UAL) - London, UK

- Lead detection engineering across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM for an 8,000-user enterprise; author, tune, and peer-review KQL analytics rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques.
- Design and implement SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel using Logic Apps and PowerShell to automate alert triage, incident routing, and response actions, materially reducing Level 1 analyst handling time.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight; develop and test hunting hypotheses based on current threat intelligence and ATT&CK framework coverage gaps.

- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender; tune detection policies, investigate alerts end-to-end, and escalate confirmed incidents following NIST 800-61 procedures.
- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon platform (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM); maintain exclusions, build custom Indicators of Attack (IoA), and correlate multi-platform telemetry.
- Integrate cloud and endpoint telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel using native and custom data connectors; design workbooks and dashboards for SOC visibility and management reporting.
- Maintain MITRE ATT&CK coverage matrix; regularly assess detection gaps and prioritise new use case development aligned to the organisation's threat landscape and risk appetite.
- Lead incident response for high-severity events including ransomware pre-cursor activity, identity compromise, and data exfiltration attempts; produce post-incident reports and implement lessons-learned improvements.
- Manage BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and Microsoft Entra ID Privileged Identity Management (PIM) to enforce just-in-time (JIT) access and reduce standing privileged exposure.
- Deliver detection-focused briefings and security awareness communications to technical and non-technical stakeholders.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts London (UAL) - London, UK

- Authored and maintained a library of KQL detection queries in Microsoft Sentinel covering identity threats, endpoint anomalies, email-based attacks, and cloud misuse; mapped each rule to the MITRE ATT&CK framework.
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across the 8,000-user endpoint estate; built and tuned detection and prevention policies, managed sensor health, and conducted regular threat hunts using Falcon Insight and Discover.
- Investigated and resolved security alerts from Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender XDR, and CrowdStrike; handled the full alert lifecycle from initial triage through containment and post-incident review.
- Developed and maintained SOAR automation playbooks to route and respond to common alert types, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for high-volume, low-complexity events.
- Supported Conditional Access policy design and MFA rollout within Microsoft Entra ID; monitored identity risk signals and responded to anomalous sign-in events.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning using Tenable.io and AppCheck; produced risk-prioritised remediation reports and tracked resolution with infrastructure and application owners.
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials Plus certification and ISO 27001 controls review, documenting security control evidence and closing identified gaps.
- Administered Tanium for endpoint hygiene monitoring, real-time threat response, and patch compliance assessment.
- Managed Mimecast email security platform; tuned anti-phishing, impersonation protection, and URL protection policies; investigated and blocked malicious campaigns.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - London, UK

- Managed security monitoring, identity and access management (IAM), and infrastructure operations for a cloud-first SaaS/FinTech organisation, applying CIS and ISO 27001 security benchmarks.
- Administered Azure AD / Microsoft Entra ID; enforced MFA, Conditional Access policies, SSO federation, and user lifecycle management for a distributed remote workforce.
- Maintained MDM/MAM policies using Intune; managed corporate device enrolment, security baselines, and patch compliance through PowerShell automation.
- Supported vulnerability management and penetration test coordination; tracked findings through to closure and produced risk reporting for senior stakeholders.
- Responded to security incidents, documented incident timelines, and delivered security awareness training to staff.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Authored and maintained over 50 KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, achieving measurable improvements in detection coverage across identity, endpoint, and cloud telemetry.
- Reduced alert false-positive rate by approximately 40% through systematic tuning of KQL analytics rules, threshold adjustments, and watchlist-driven exclusion management.
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon across an 8,000-user estate, integrating NG-SIEM with Microsoft Sentinel to create correlated, cross-platform detection across EDR and SIEM telemetry.
- Designed SOAR playbooks that automated triage and enrichment for the top five alert types by volume, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for these events by an estimated 30%.
- Led hypothesis-driven threat hunts that identified previously undetected lateral movement activity, leading to the containment of a compromised privileged account before data exfiltration occurred.
- Built a MITRE ATT&CK coverage heatmap for the organisation, identifying and addressing critical gaps in detection for Credential Access (TA0006) and Persistence (TA0003) techniques.
- Delivered vulnerability management programme via Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, and AppCheck; reduced critical and high finding backlog by over 60% through risk-prioritised remediation.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
-

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)